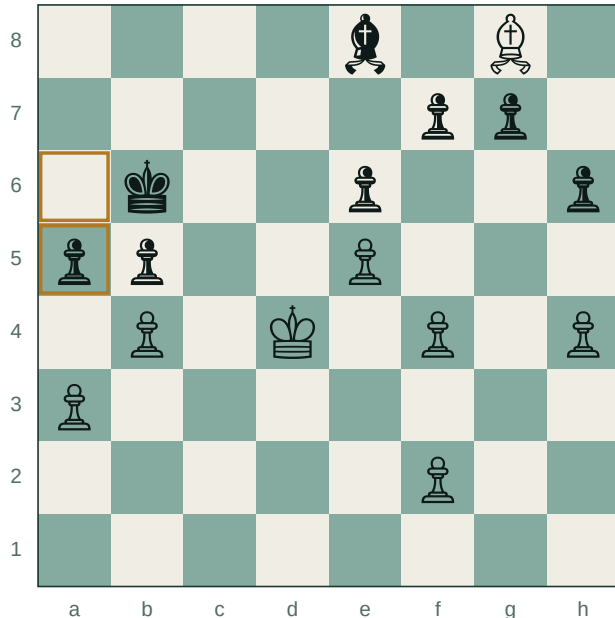


Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 37

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 36...a5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. bxa5+ Kxa5 38. Kc5

37.bxa5+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on a5. Recorded reply: **37...Kxa5**.

38.Kc5 The king moves from d4 to c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on b6. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e8. Check for tactical protection.